

Title Page

- **Name:** Shlok Mahesh Thakur
- **Reg No.:** 25BAI10020
- **Branch:** B.Tech CSE (AIML)
- **Year:** First Year
- **Course Code:** CSE0001
- **Course:** Digital Literacy
- **Date:** March 30, 2026

Introduction

In the rapidly evolving landscape of the 21st century, digital literacy has transitioned from a specialized skill to a fundamental necessity for academic and professional success. As a first-year B.Tech student specializing in Artificial Intelligence and Machine Learning (AIML), I have undertaken this project in the role of a Student Digital Ambassador. My objective is to build a comprehensive Digital Literacy Portfolio that serves as a guide for my peers to navigate the online world safely and professionally. This portfolio documents five critical modules: creating visual awareness resources, establishing a professional identity on platforms like GitHub and LinkedIn, mastering coding and

cloud collaboration tools, practicing formal email etiquette, and analyzing cybercrime prevention. By completing these tasks, I aim to demonstrate the technical and ethical competencies required to

thrive in a digital-first academic environment at VIT Bhopal.

Task 1 Write-up: Awareness Infographic

For the first task as a Student Digital Ambassador, I created a one-page digital literacy awareness infographic using **Canva**. The visual resource was designed to help my batchmates understand the core pillars of digital literacy. My design specifically covers three critical areas: **Safe Internet Practices**, **Professional Online Presence**, and **Email Etiquette**. I chose a clean, professional layout with icons and brief bullet points to ensure the information is easily digestible for a student audience. **Reflection:** Using Canva was an interesting experience because of its vast library of

templates and drag-and-drop features. One thing I found particularly interesting was learning how to balance visual elements with text to convey a message without overwhelming the reader. The most difficult part was narrowing down the vast topic of digital literacy into just three key sections while keeping the design aesthetic and professional. This task reinforced that as an ambassador, my communication must be both visually appealing and informative.

Task 1 Write-up: Awareness Infographic

For the first task as a Student Digital Ambassador, I created a one-page digital literacy awareness infographic using **Canva**. The visual resource was designed to help my batchmates understand the core pillars of digital literacy. My design specifically covers three critical areas: **Safe Internet Practices**, **Professional Online Presence**, and **Email Etiquette**. I chose a clean, professional layout with icons and brief bullet points to ensure the information is easily digestible for a student audience.

+4

Reflection: Using Canva was an interesting experience because of its vast library of templates and drag-and-drop features. One thing I found particularly interesting was learning how to balance visual elements with text to convey a message without overwhelming the reader. The most difficult part was narrowing down the vast topic of digital literacy into just three key sections while keeping the design aesthetic and professional. This task reinforced that as an ambassador, my communication must be both visually appealing and informative.

+1

Task 2 Write-up: Student Digital Portfolio

In Task 2, I established a foundational professional presence by setting up and updating profiles on **GitHub**, **ResearchGate**, and **Kaggle**. On GitHub, I created a specialized profile README that includes my name, branch (CSE AIML), and my learning goals for the year. For ResearchGate, I set up a profile to follow academic publications and stay updated on the latest trends in Artificial Intelligence and Machine Learning.

Purpose and Future Plans: I chose these platforms because they are critical for a student in the AIML branch. While GitHub serves as a repository for my coding projects and version control,

ResearchGate allows me to connect with the global academic community and access peer-reviewed research. Kaggle is essential for practicing data science and participating in machine learning competitions. Over the next four years, I plan to use GitHub daily to document my Python projects, while ResearchGate will be my primary tool for literature reviews and staying informed about

cutting-edge AI research. This digital portfolio ensures that I am prepared for both industry challenges and academic research opportunities.

Task 3 Write-up: Coding & Collaboration Platforms (150–200 words)

Task 3 involved exploring platforms for technical practice and cloud-based collaboration. For the coding portion, I used **HackerRank** and completed the "Solve Me First" Python challenge to

familiarize myself with the platform's environment. For the collaboration portion, I designed a 5- question **Google Form** titled "Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz". The form includes multiple-choice and short-answer questions designed to test my peers' knowledge of online safety.

Academic Utility: These tools are vital for my academic success in the CSE AIML branch. HackerRank helps me build the problem-solving logic required for technical interviews and coding exams. Google Forms and Workspace tools are essential for group projects, such as my current EVS project on Bangalore's sustainability, as they allow for efficient data collection and team coordination.

Mastering these platforms now ensures that I can collaborate effectively on complex engineering projects in the future.

Task 4 Write-up: Professional Email & Etiquette Guide

For this task, I focused on mastering professional digital communication, which is a core responsibility of a Student Digital Ambassador. I drafted two formal emails: one to **Professor Kannan** requesting an assignment extension and another to an internship coordinator expressing interest in a summer role. Additionally, I developed a comprehensive "Social Media Do's and Don'ts" checklist to guide my peers toward responsible online behavior.

Reflection: This task highlighted how critical tone and structure are in professional settings. I learned that a clear subject line and a respectful greeting can significantly impact how a request is received. A common communication pitfall is using overly casual language in academic emails, which can lead to misunderstandings. By creating the social media guide, I realized that as an AIML student, maintaining a clean and professional digital footprint is essential, as future employers often review

these profiles during the hiring process.

Task 5 Write-up: Cybercrime Awareness & Prevention

In the final task, I researched a real-world identity theft case involving **Karan Kumar Ram**, whose personal documents were stolen to facilitate a ₹48 crore financial fraud. I also created a "Stay Safe Online" prevention checklist specifically for college students, which includes mandatory reporting details for the **National Cyber Crime Portal** and the **1930 Helpline**.

Reflection: What surprised me most during this research was the sheer scale of the fraud that can be committed using just basic identification documents like an Aadhaar or PAN card. It was eye-opening to see how a lack of digital vigilance can lead to years of legal and financial distress. As a direct result, I have personally changed my habit of sharing document scans over unverified messaging apps. I am now much more cautious about my UPI safety, ensuring I never enter a PIN to receive money, and I plan to educate my batchmates on these same protective measures.

Conclusion

Completing the Digital Literacy project has been a pivotal step in my transition into the academic environment at VIT Bhopal. By stepping into the role of a Student Digital Ambassador, I have

transformed from a passive user of technology into a responsible digital citizen equipped with professional-grade tools. Throughout this project, I have successfully built a versatile portfolio on GitHub and ResearchGate, mastered cloud-based collaboration through Google Workspace, and deepened my understanding of the ethical landscape of cybersecurity.

The most significant takeaway from this experience is the realization that technical expertise in AIML must be balanced with strong "soft" digital skills, such as professional email etiquette and a vigilant approach to online safety. These modules have provided me with a competitive edge and a solid foundation for my future career in engineering. I am now prepared to not only manage my own

digital footprint but also to serve as a reliable resource for my peers as we navigate the complexities of the modern digital world.

References

- **Canva (Infographic Tool):** canva.com
- **GitHub (Version Control & Portfolio):** github.com
- **ResearchGate:** researchgate.net
- **Kaggle:** kaggle.com
- **HackerRank (Coding Practice):** hackerrank.com
- **Google Forms (Collaboration):** forms.google.com
- **National Cyber Crime Portal:** [suspicious link removed]
- **National Cyber Crime Helpline:** 1930